

When Jesus wept

Text: William Billings, *The New-England Psalm-Singer*, 1770

Music: William Billings, *The New-England Psalm-Singer*, 1770

WHEN JESUS WEPT 8.8.8.8

The musical score is written for a single voice on a treble clef staff with a key signature of one sharp (F#) and a 3/2 time signature. It consists of four lines of music, each starting with a measure number (1, 2, 3, 4) in the first measure. The lyrics are written below the notes, with hyphens indicating syllables that span multiple notes. The first line ends with a comma, and the second line ends with a period. The third and fourth lines end with a double bar line. The notes are primarily quarter and half notes, with some eighth notes and rests. The melody is simple and hymn-like.

1
When Je - sus wept, the fall - ing tear

2
in mer - cy flowed be - yond all bound.

3
When Je - sus groaned, a trem - bling fear

4
seized all the guilt - y world a - round.

A four-voice round: each voice enters in turn, one measure apart.